PRACTITIONER REFERENCE

Head Spa Contraindication Chart

A quick screen, not a diagnosis. When in doubt, don't start and ask for written medical clearance.

KEY **No** Don't provide **Wait** Postpone **Refer** Doctor OK first Gentle Light, no heat *Caution* Modify OK Proceed

IF CLIENT HAS	Ritual	Exfoliation	Steam	Hot oil	High freq	LED
SCALP & SKIN						
Head lice [1]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Ringworm, impetigo, folliculitis [2]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Open sores or broken skin [3]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Psoriasis or eczema flare [4]	Gentle	**No**	**Wait**	Gentle	**Wait**	*Caution*
Seborrheic dermatitis flare [5]	Gentle	**No**	**Wait**	*Caution*	**Wait**	*Caution*
Sunburned scalp [6]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Scalp surgery or hair transplant [7]	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**
Chemical service <72 h [8]	Gentle	**Wait**	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK
Botox or fillers, forehead/neck [9]	Gentle	*Caution*	*Caution*	Gentle	**Wait**	*Caution*
HEALTH						
Neck/spine problems, vertigo [10]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	Gentle	*Caution*	*Caution*
Past stroke [11]	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**	**Refer**
Migraine [12]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
High blood pressure, heart [13]	*Caution*	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*	**Refer**	OK
Pacemaker or implanted device [14]	OK	OK	OK	OK	**No**	*Caution*
Metal implants, head or neck [15]	OK	OK	OK	OK	**No**	OK
Epilepsy [16]	OK	OK	OK	*Caution*	**No**	*Caution*
Pregnancy [17]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**	*Caution*
Photosensitizing medicine [18]	OK	*Caution*	OK	OK	OK	*Caution*
ALLERGY & CONSENT						
Fragrance or oil allergy [19]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	OK
Nut allergy [20]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	OK
Minor, no guardian consent [21]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**

[1] Contagious. Reschedule; disinfect tools and bed.
[2] Contagious or infected. No service; refer.
[3] Wait until healed; no product on broken skin.
[4] No friction or heat; suggest a dermatologist.
[5] Fragrance-free and gentle; skip heavy oils.
[6] Wait until healed; then sunscreen or a hat.
[7] Surgeon OK in writing, often [6–12] months.
[8] Color-safe products; no exfoliation for [72] h.
[9] No pressure near injections [24 h–2 wk].
[10] Flat bed or neck support; no backward tilt.
[11] Doctor OK first; flat bed, neutral neck.
[12] Ask about triggers: scent, heat, light, pressure.
[13] Limit heat and steam; HF needs doctor OK.
[14] No high frequency. Check the LED maker's advice.
[15] No high frequency near metal implants.
[16] No high frequency; no flashing LED modes.
[17] Side support, minimal essential oils [policy].
[18] Retinoids thin skin; some drugs react to light.
[19] Fragrance-free products; no aromatherapy.
[20] Nut-free oils, scrubs and masks; read labels.
[21] Parent or guardian consent required [policy].

Conservative defaults; check your state board rules. Device and product makers, state rules and the client's doctor come first. Dizziness, numbness or vision changes at the bowl: stop and sit the client up slowly.